

ACTIVITY 1 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Stakeholder Influence Mapping

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Role Play	25 minutes	LU1	LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to identify internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand (LU1).

What learners produce

A Power-Interest map with 12 stakeholders placed and an engagement approach written against each quadrant.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of exactly 3 so every role is played. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. All 17 activities run on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario, so remind learners of where this activity sits in that story before you start.

Scenario / briefing material

Nimbus Wellness Pte Ltd, a 25-person Singapore boutique skincare and wellness brand, is three months from its 5th-anniversary relaunch. The founder has committed to a new sustainable-packaging line as the centrepiece of the relaunch story.

Not everyone is convinced. Retail operations worries the new packaging will raise unit cost and slow reorders. A wellness retail chain that carries Nimbus in 40 outlets wants proof the change won't disrupt supply before it commits fresh shelf space. Meanwhile a vocal community of long-time customers on social media is already asking why Nimbus hasn't "gone green" sooner.

Before the founder locks the relaunch brief, your table must map who genuinely has power and interest in this decision — and design how to bring each group along, not just announce it to them.

Roles

Assign one role per participant:

- **The Founder** — *Goal: Protect the relaunch vision.* Wants sustainability to be the headline story of the anniversary campaign and is impatient with anything that looks like delay.
- **Retail Operations Lead** — *Goal: Protect margin and delivery reliability.* Worried the new packaging supplier will slow reorders right before the relaunch peak season.
- **Retail Partner Buyer** — *Goal: Protect their own shelf-space risk.* Will only commit expanded shelf space once supply reliability through the transition is proven.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Set up the grid. Draw a 2×2 grid on your worksheet or flipchart. Label the horizontal axis Interest (low → high) and the vertical axis Power (low → high). Name the four quadrants: Monitor (low/low), Keep Informed (low power/high interest), Keep Satisfied (high power/low interest), Manage Closely (high/high).	Watch for tables that place every stakeholder in Manage Closely — push them: if everything is a priority, nothing is.
2	Assign the three roles. One person takes the Founder, one the Retail Operations Lead, one the Retail Partner Buyer. Everyone else at the table acts as the brand team facilitating. Role-holders answer in character for the rest of the activity.	The vocal customer community is the instructive case: high interest, low formal power, but capable of becoming high power overnight through social media.
3	List stakeholders individually first. Working alone for three minutes, write down every stakeholder group touched by the sustainable-packaging relaunch decision. Aim for at least eight. Working alone first prevents the loudest voice at the table from anchoring the list.	If a table finishes early, ask them what changes if the retail partner voices hesitation publicly tomorrow.
4	Pool and split internal from external. Combine the individual lists on one sheet. Draw a line down the middle: internal (management, employees, operations) on the left; external (customers, retail partners, investors, media, regulators) on the right. Trim or merge duplicates until you have 6 internal and 6 external — 12 in total.	
5	Interview the three roles for their real concern. Ask each role-holder in turn: “What is your actual worry here?” Write the stated position and, underneath it, the underlying concern. The gap between the two is the point of this step — the Retail Partner Buyer’s stated position is	

	about shelf space, but the real concern is supply reliability.	
6	Plot all 12 on the grid. Place each stakeholder in a quadrant based on power (can they stop or change this decision?) and interest (how much do they care about the outcome?). Where the table disagrees, argue it out — the disagreement is where the learning is.	
7	Match an engagement approach to each quadrant. Assign one approach per quadrant: Manage Closely → co-design; Keep Satisfied → consult; Keep Informed → brief regularly; Monitor → light-touch watch. Then sanity-check each stakeholder: does that approach actually address the underlying concern you recorded earlier?	
8	Prepare the debrief line. Agree one sentence: “The stakeholder we would most easily have under-managed is _____, because _____.” Nominate a spokesperson.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
3 min	Brief the scenario and assign the three roles
7 min	Individually list stakeholders, then pool them at the table
8 min	Plot each stakeholder on the Power-Interest Grid
5 min	Agree an engagement approach per quadrant
2 min	Prepare your one-sentence rationale for the debrief

Total: 25 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Which 6 internal and 6 external stakeholders matter most to this relaunch decision, and why?
2. Using the Power-Interest Grid, where does each stakeholder sit — and which quadrant deserves your table's limited attention this month?
3. What is each stakeholder's real underlying concern, not just their stated position?
4. What engagement approach — brief, consult or co-design — fits each stakeholder's concern and influence level?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- Which stakeholder's position surprised you once you heard their actual concern instead of assuming it?
- Did power and interest always move together on your map, or did a low-power/high-interest voice turn out to be worth listening to anyway?
- If the retail partner buyer voiced hesitation publicly tomorrow, how would that change your grid?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Watch for tables that place every stakeholder in Manage Closely — push them: if everything is a priority, nothing is.
- The vocal customer community is the instructive case: high interest, low formal power, but capable of becoming high power overnight through social media.
- If a table finishes early, ask them what changes if the retail partner voices hesitation publicly tomorrow.

Success criterion

Every group can show a completed Power-Interest map with both internal and external stakeholders placed, and an engagement approach per quadrant that matches the stakeholder's real concern — not just their job title.

Assessment link

This activity builds LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation. All 17 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same techniques on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.